YUYAY ANALYTICS

Clemencia Vela, MSc

PRINCIPAL CONSULTANT | INTERNATIONAL EVALUATION & SUSTAINABILITY

Environmental programme evaluation · Biodiversity · Climate adaptation · Sustainable development

Quito, Ecuador | clemvela@gmail.com | Spanish · English · French (intermediate)

PROFILE

International environmental evaluation specialist with more than four decades of experience in biodiversity conservation, environmental management, climate change adaptation, protected areas, and sustainable development. Has led and contributed to independent evaluations and institutional initiatives across Latin America and the Caribbean for multilateral and international organizations.

SELECTED INTERNATIONAL EVALUATION ASSIGNMENTS

UNEP | Global Peatlands Initiative | 2024–2025 — Terminal review of an initiative focused on assessing, measuring, and preserving peat carbon.

UNODC | Colombia | 2023–2024 — Final in-depth evaluation of institutional capacity-building to address illegal deforestation.

UNEP / EU | Caribbean Biological Corridor | 2022–2023 — Terminal evaluation of a regional biodiversity initiative.

UNEP / GEF | Conservation Agreements | 2021–2022 — Latin American portfolio responsibilities covering five countries and 18 sites.

UNDP Independent Evaluation Office | Ecuador | 2021 — Environmental portfolio evaluation, including climate change and national environmental initiatives.

GEF Independent Evaluation Office | Caribbean SIDS | 2019 — Case studies covering Belize, Saint Lucia, and the Dominican Republic.

UNDP / GEF | Mexico | 2016–2017 — Evaluation of biodiversity-rich community forest management.

FAO / GEF | Ecuador | 2017 — Evaluation of natural resources management, resilience, food and water security in Chimborazo.

UNEP | Peru | 2016 — Terminal evaluation of ecosystem-based adaptation for mountain ecosystems.

UNDP | Cuba | 2015 — Mid-term evaluations concerning desertification, drought, and sustainable land management.

UNDP / GEF | Venezuela | 2013 — Led evaluations of marine-coastal protected areas and national parks sustainability.

UNDP | Argentina / Uruguay | 2013 — Led evaluation of the FREPLATA pollution prevention programme.

UNDP | Honduras | 2012 — Led evaluation of biodiversity conservation in Indigenous landscapes of La Moskitia.

UNDP / GEF | Chile | 2011 — Led evaluation of Valdivian temperate rainforest protected areas.

GEF / UNDP | El Salvador | 2010–2011 — Country portfolio and results-to-impact studies, including biodiversity conservation in coffee plantations.

UNDP | Central America | 2007 — Regional evaluation of the Mesoamerican Biological Corridor.

ENVIRONMENTAL LEADERSHIP & ADVISORY EXPERIENCE

Ecuadorian Foundation for Research and Environmental Management | Acting Director | 1993–2008 — Led conservation research and protected-area initiatives, including the Cordillera del Cóndor and Arenillas.

World Bank / IDB / Ecuadorian institutions — Environmental assessments, programme evaluations, institutional strengthening, risk management and conservation planning.

Environmental impact assessment — Infrastructure, roads, hydroelectric development, water supply, oil activities, and environmental permitting.

SPECIALIZATIONS

Programme and terminal evaluation — Theory of Change, results-to-impact, monitoring and evaluation indicators.

Sustainability and conservation — Biodiversity, protected areas, Indigenous and local communities, climate adaptation, sustainable land management.

International consulting — Multilateral programmes, regional evaluation, stakeholder engagement, environmental governance.

EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

MSc Ecology | University of Aberdeen, Scotland | 1985

Licenciatura in Biology | Pontificia Universidad Católica del Ecuador — Studies also at University of Chile.

Additional training — ISO 14000 environmental management systems; GIS; environmental impact assessment; limnology.

PROFESSIONAL NETWORKS

RELAC, REDLACME, IOCE / EvalPartners — Participation in international evaluation networks and working groups.